AI for Economics — Session 2: Writing as a Human

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PART 1. 오프닝 약 1.2분

[Slide 1 — Writing as a Human]

Today is the second session of **AI for Economics**.

[Slide 2 — Three things today]

Using AI well is not only about using the tool better. In a broader sense, it also means **knowing which tasks to give to AI and which to do yourself**, and **working to get better at the ones you keep**. With that in mind, I'll talk about three things today. **First**, what makes good writing. **Second**, how studying international studies can help you achieve it. **Third**, some ways of using AI for writing.

PART 2. 좋은 글이란 무엇인가 약 2.0분

[Slide 2 (계속) — What makes good writing? KTG (전용 슬라이드 없음)]

In our department, there is an academic society called KIC The Globe, or KTG. I was there for two years, doing some writing and feedback. I learned what makes good writing: **structure, a unique perspective, supporting facts, and clarity**.

[Slide 2 (계속) — 전용 슬라이드 없음]

But the pieces I liked the most had something more. They were written with **a strong urge to say something**, and they were **connecting things that didn't seem to be connected**.

[Slide 3 — Mario essay]

In some sense, this is an example of good writing. It got an F, but it connects **Super Mario with philosophical theory**. It may not be a good essay, but it has **a strong urge to say something**.

[Slide 3 (계속) — 같은 슬라이드에서 이어서]

If you want to write with a strong urge and your own statement, **you must have your own perspective**. Those perspectives come from **the theories you learn at the university**.

PART 3. 프랑스 사례: 국제학은 어떻게 쓰이는가 약 5.5분

[Slide 4 — Student protests]

Let's say I want to write about France. This is just an example to show how **international studies** can be applied to things happening in the world.

[Slide 5 — France: three areas (cards)]

This situation is related to three areas we learn in our department: **economics, political theories, and business**.

[Slide 6 — Economics ①: government balance, social protection, pensions]

First, **economics**. The French government has run a **deficit every year since 2000**. In 2024 it was **5.8% of GDP**, far below the **EU limit of minus 3%**. A big reason is social spending. France spends **23% of GDP on social protection**, and **pensions alone cost 13.6% of GDP**.

[Slide 7 — Economics ②: real GDP per capita, productivity]

At the same time, **growth is weak**. Since 2000, real GDP per capita has grown **20% in France**, compared with **25% in Germany** and **40% in the US**. Behind this is **slower productivity growth**, which makes it harder to pay for a large welfare state.

[Slide 8 — International Relations]

From the **welfare state model** in **Contemporary Theories of IR**, **France is spending too much on social protection and pensions**. **Fiscal stress and political deadlock can increase support for illiberal or populist parties.** And this is not only France: in 2025, **populist parties led the polls in Britain, France and Germany at the same time**. That is a hypothesis we can test with IR theories.

[Slide 9 — Business Finance: France–Germany bond yield spread]

Last but not least is **business finance**. A bond rate consists of **common interest rate factors such as maturity, expected inflation, and real rate**. On top of that is the **spread**. This is a **country-specific premium**, and it also includes **political risk**. So the political instability we discuss in IR shows up directly in the interest rate. We compare France with **Germany** because German bonds, rated **AAA**, are **the euro area's benchmark**, so the gap shows **France-specific risk**. Over the past year, the **France–Germany 10-year spread** averaged **0.77 percentage points**, and on **20 October it reached 1.52**.

[Slide 10 — Through which framework are we looking?]

Remember what I said makes good writing: **a unique perspective**, **connecting things that don't seem to be connected**, and **supporting facts**. Without a framework, a student protest is just a protest. Through **economics, IR, and business finance**, the same protest connects to **deficits, slow growth, populism, and bond markets**, and each link is backed by data. So if you want to write well, you have to have **a framework** you are looking through, and that framework is what you build in our department.

PART 4. AI를 글쓰기에 쓰는 세 단계 약 1.7분

[Slide 11 — Three steps of using AI]

Now I'll show you **three steps of using AI** when writing an essay.

[Slides 12–13 — Step 1: Research (News, Literature)]

Step 1: Research. You can connect the current situation with other areas, and check whether they are directly related. It is also a good idea to look for recent literature.

[Slide 14 — Step 2: Data Processing & Visualization]

Step 2: Data processing and visualization. In 2022, I had to check the Excel file and write the Python code by myself. Nowadays, it takes just **one minute** to make a graph.

[Slide 15 — Step 3: Fact-Check & Articulation]

Step 3: Fact-check and articulation. You can use AI to fact-check or restructure your writing.

[Slide 15 (계속) — You verify and decide (전용 슬라이드 없음)]

Through all three steps, **you are the one who verifies and decides**. AI helps with finding, processing, and checking, but we are the ones who should be thinking.

PART 5. 마무리 약 0.4분

[Slide 16 — Writing as a Human]

I hope this session gave you some idea of **writing as a human**, and of how our department is not just a mix of shallow courses. Thank you.